200603 M5|L1 Lab End-of-Life (EOL) Plan Format

Exercise 4: Develop an end-of-life (EOL) plan for the scenario

EOL planning category	Planning considerations
Product identification	• Product Name: Mobile WB-3000 • Part of LWT mobile whiteboard product line • Planned replacement via upgraded spin-off model
Rationale	• Planned obsolescence strategy approved by CEO • Technology advancement and cost-benefit analysis support retirement after two years
Retirement strategy	• Spin-off strategy to introduce updated model • Gradual phase-out over one year
Proposed mitigation plan	• Incentives for customers to upgrade • Warranty and service contracts honored • Issues management hotline established
Communications planning	• Customer notifications sent six months prior • Clear transition timelines communicated • Partner and distributor briefings
Internal impact	• Manufacturing: Gradual production wind-down • Customer support: Continued support during transition • Sales: Transition messaging and upgrade incentives • HR and Legal: Contract and compliance management
External impact	• Customer support maintained through retirement • Partner coordination for inventory transition
Cost analysis	• Marketing estimates indicate maintenance costs exceed benefits after three years • Retirement approved through executive review
Scheduling	• Replacement communication: Launch +18 months • Product transition and retirement: Launch +24 months • Retirement phase duration: One year
Risk analysis	• Customer dissatisfaction • Inventory surplus • Communication gaps • Mitigated through phased rollout and incentives
Critical success factors (CSF)	• Smooth customer transition • Minimal support disruption • Successful adoption of upgraded product • CSF tracked via customer satisfaction and upgrade rates